

E-COMMERCE ARCHITECTURE STRATEGY

The Stateful Preview Shell

Why standard headless CMS visual authoring falls flat on transactional data—and why a hybrid "Buy + Orchestrate" blueprint saves engineering months and unlocks marketing agility.

PREPARED FOR: VP OF ENGINEERING & PRODUCT

| The Core Technical Divide

Traditional Headless CMS Preview

Optimized for static fields (blogs and standard text). It treats dynamic e-commerce features—like personalized pricing, regional stock limits, and active checkout criteria—as static, blank mocked fields.

Risk: Broken production layouts, stale inventory display, and critical pricing discrepancies during live campaigns.

State-Aware Orchestration Shell

A native viewport wrapper built inside our Next.js frontend application stack. It acts as the "eyes," instantly matching incoming headless CMS text streams with our actual, live e-commerce databases and cart APIs.

Benefit: Complete confidence. Authors preview live regional prices, inventory counts, and customer VIP tier layouts natively.

Risk & Lifecycle Resolution Matrix

The VP's Critical Objections	The "Off-The-Shelf Only" Hidden Costs	Our Hybrid Strategy (Buy + Build)
"Just configure Contentful's Preview API"	Forces continuous database synchronization pipelines or brittle, slow mock-up layers within their custom iframe sandboxes.	BUILD SHELL Own the orchestration layer natively in Next.js. Avoid the API sync tax entirely.
"You are creating a massive Bus Factor"	Developers get locked into specialized, costly, and highly proprietary CMS customization setups.	REACT STANDARD No bespoke code. Any frontend engineer can maintain standard React visual containers.
"CMS ships with versioning, history, & workflows"	Building complex revision history logs or localization workflows from scratch will inevitably drain engineering resources.	BUY CMS **We still buy Contentful/Sanity.** We use their backend for state-of-the-art workflows while rendering drafts in our shell.